Lesson 15 Teacher's Key: Ready to Show

Unity - Instructor Reference Only

VIDEO GAME CREATION

How This Key Is Different Today

There's no new Level 1 solution to give this week - Lesson 15 is a polish-and-present day, not a new-mechanic day. This Key instead consolidates the most common last-mile issues seen across this engine's Lessons 2-14, to help you diagnose a stuck student quickly during polish time.

Known Recurring Quirks in This Engine

- An Inspector field left unassigned after adding a new public variable (common this semester with explosionPrefab, roundAudioSrc, etc.), producing a NullReferenceException at the worst moment.
- A prefab edited in the Hierarchy but never applied back to the actual Prefab asset, so changes don't persist or show up for other instances.
- GameManager.instance not yet assigned if Awake() ordering is inconsistent across multiple GameManager-like objects accidentally left in the scene.

Fast Diagnostic Questions

- "Check the Console for a red error" - Unity's NullReferenceException messages usually name the exact missing field.
- "Is there more than one GameManager in the scene?" - a surprisingly common source of confusing singleton behavior by this point.

If a Student Is Significantly Behind

Prioritize getting Lessons 6-11's Level 1 (win/lose, restart, multiple waves) solidly working before anything from Lessons 12-14 - a complete, simple game presents better than a broken ambitious one.

Presentation Day Notes

- Have students press Play from a fresh Editor state (not mid-Play-mode-edit) before presenting, since Unity discards Play-mode-only changes on stop.